APPLICATION PLAYBOOK · CLASS OF 2027

10,000 Black Interns from zero to strongest applicant

What the programme is, how it is funded, what happens to your application after you press submit, and a working guide to Investment Management, Sales and Public Relations, so your three 250-word answers read like they were written by someone who already understands the job.

1 Nov 2026
Applications close

23 Nov 2026
Employers get their candidate lists

25–50
Candidates per role, on average

250 words
Is your cover letter for each workstream

Prepared 11 October 2026 from the 10,000 Interns Foundation's own student and employer FAQs, the Charity Commission register and press coverage. Sources are listed on the last page. Fee and industry figures are rounded, typical ranges for understanding, not quotes.

START HERE

The six things that matter most

1. **Your 250-word answer is your cover letter.** The employer FAQ says candidates apply to up to three workstreams, "each with a CV and a cover letter of 250 words maximum". Each workstream answer is a cover letter, so write it like one.
2. **Nobody at 10K ranks you.** After an eligibility check, an algorithm matches you to employers *at random* within your chosen workstream and location. The employer then does all of the selecting.
3. **One allocation goes to one firm.** Your CV and that workstream's answer go to a single organisation, which sees you alongside roughly 25–50 other candidates for the same role. You might get several allocations, one, or none.
4. **You can't choose the firm, so you can't name the firm.** Write for the whole workstream: show that you understand how *any* firm in that industry works and makes money. That is the specificity that wins.
5. **Each answer is read by a different kind of reader.** A PR agency reading your PR answer does not care that Investment Management was your first choice. Every answer has to stand on its own.
6. **Your CV is locked at submission.** Finalise it before 1 November. You can only send an updated version to a firm that contacts you afterwards.

Contents

1. **The programme from zero.** What it is, who started it, how a charity like this is funded, and who takes part.
2. **What happens when you press submit.** The allocation algorithm, the timeline and what it means for you.
3. **Who actually reads your 250 words.** The reader you are writing for.
4. **Investment Management.** The four parts of an asset manager, how it makes money, and a detailed look at the client-facing side.
5. **Sales.** The four parts of a sales organisation, the funnel, the economics, and how your experience transfers.
6. **Public Relations.** The disciplines, agency versus in-house, how PR earns money, and the financial PR bridge.
7. **Writing the answers.** A 250-word structure, a specificity ladder and three draft templates.
8. **Strategy beyond the form.** Location, speed of response, interviews, and a plan from today to 1 November.

Your edge in one sentence

Most applicants will write "I'm passionate about finance and want to develop my skills." You already have asset-management experience, so you can write about *how the business actually works*, e.g. AUM, fees, distribution, client retention. That is the gap between a generic answer and one a hiring manager forwards to an interview list.

PART 1

The programme from zero

What it is

10,000 Black Interns is the flagship programme of the **10,000 Interns Foundation**, a UK registered charity (no. 1199061). It does not employ you and it is not a recruitment agency. It is a **matchmaker plus training provider**. Employers pledge paid internships, Black students and graduates apply once, and the Foundation's system routes applications to those employers. It also runs training, mentoring and an alumni network around that process.

What employers must commit to

- Paid at least the **Real Living Wage** for the location, for the whole internship
- At least **6 weeks**, usually in summer (internships run May–September 2027)
- UK-based (remote or hybrid allowed)
- A dedicated line manager *and* a mentor from inside the organisation

What you get beyond the internship

- Pre-application CV and cover-letter workshops and sector deep dives
- Interview training, then pre-internship training (April–June 2027)
- 1:1 mentoring and networking
- The 10,000 Alumni Programme (events, jobs board, mentoring)
- Wellbeing support (Black Minds Matter, Turn2Us)

Where it came from

It started **in investment management**, which matters for you. In 2020 a group of senior industry figures ran the **#100BlackInterns** pilot to tackle the near-absence of Black talent in UK fund management. Around 80 firms, including M&G, Schroders and St James's Place, offered paid front-office internships. The founders were:

- **Dawid Konotey-Ahulu**: co-founder of Redington (an investment consultancy advising pension funds) and Mallowstreet
- **Jonathan Sorrell**: President of Capstone Investment Advisors (a hedge fund that funded the launch)
- **Wol Kolade**: Managing Partner of Livingbridge (private equity)
- **Michael Barrington-Hibbert**: founder of Barrington Hibbert Associates (executive search)

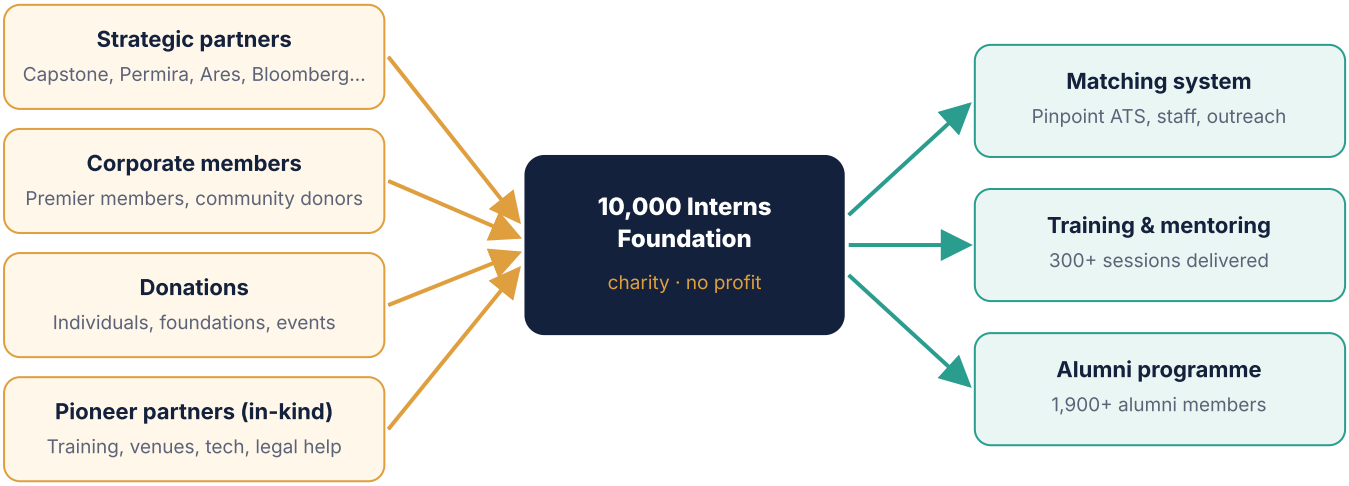
2020	#100BlackInterns pilot in investment management
2021	10,000 Black Interns launches across sectors; 700+ firms and 2,000+ applications in year one
2022	10,000 Able Interns (disabled students) launches; expands into insurance, banking, tech, real estate
2023–24	Arts & Culture strand; first impact report
2025	10,000 internship milestone reached; Alumni Programme launched
2026/27 (you)	"Beyond 10,000": 1,300+ employers engaged across 35+ sectors and 47 workstreams

Why this matters for your answers: investment management is the programme's home sector. The founders' networks are asset managers, consultants and private equity, and the IM workstream is likely to be one of the deepest pools of hosts.

PART 1 CONTINUED

How the Foundation makes money

It is a **charity, not a business**, so it doesn't make a profit. It needs income to cover staff, the Pinpoint application system, training and events. Crucially, **employers pay nothing to host**. The employer FAQ says "there is no fee to join the programme. The only required expense is intern salaries." That keeps the barrier low enough for 1,300+ organisations to take part.



Host employers pay their interns' salaries directly. No fee flows to the Foundation for hosting.

Charity Commission data	Year to 31 Dec 2022	2023	2024
Total income (all donations & legacies)	£1.07m	£0.91m	£0.82m
Total spending	n/a	n/a	£1.26m (≈£1.0m on charitable activities)

It spent more than it raised in 2024, which is common for a charity drawing on reserves. It is a small organisation running a very large marketplace, and the employers do the expensive part (paying and training interns).

Why firms take part (useful for your interviews)

Talent pipeline. A cheap, pre-screened route to diverse candidates who may convert to graduate hires.

Diversity targets. Firms report on ethnicity, and regulators such as the FCA scrutinise culture and inclusion in financial services.

Low cost, low admin. No fee. The firm pays the salary and runs its own selection.

Who partners with them

Funders and partners listed by the Foundation: Ares, Bloomberg, Buttinghill Foundation, BVCA (British Private Equity & Venture Capital Association), Cappfinity, Capstone, Christie's, GAIN UK, IBM, LinkedIn, Mayor of London, Permira, Q5, Royal Academy of Arts, Russell Group, Smart Works, The Money Charity, Twilio and the University of Oxford. Pinpoint provides the application system and Montfort (a financial PR firm) provides PR support.

Host employers named in public coverage over the years: M&G, Schroders, St James's Place, LGIM, HSBC, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, Investec, Allianz, Deutsche Bank, RWC Partners, Capstone, Canaccord Genuity Wealth Management, Trillium, OneFamily, Pinsent Masons and Framestore, plus Bar chambers via the Bar Council.

Be realistic: there is no public, current list of 2027 hosts, and the roster changes every year. Hosts pledged roles between 28 September and 30 October 2026. It also doesn't matter much, because you **cannot choose your employer**. Firms you want specifically should also get a **direct** application.

PART 2

What happens when you press submit

You asked whether 10K sends everything to every firm, or narrows it down and sends the best. **It does neither.** It runs a random, rules-based match. Firms do all the judging.

1 · You apply
CV, cover letter, 3 workstreams (250 words each), preferred location

›

2 · Eligibility check
Heritage, right to work, student/graduate status. No quality ranking.

›

3 · Algorithm
Randomly matches you to pledged roles in your workstreams and location

›

4 · Allocation
One firm receives your CV and that workstream's answer on its "slate"

›

5 · Firm selects
Its own process: CV screen, tests, video or interview

The rules, straight from the FAQs

- Matching uses **only workstream + location**. Employers are told candidates are "not filtered by other factors".
- Each allocation = **one organisation**. You may get several, one, or none.
- An employer receives **25–50 candidates per role** on average, and can request more.
- If your first-choice workstream is full, you may be placed in an **adjacent workstream**.
- You **can't swap** allocations or ask for extra ones. A rejection is not reallocated.
- New allocations can arrive **up to June** as new roles are added.
- Firms see **only their own slate**. Everyone else should apply direct.
- Emails come from **Pinpoint** or the firm itself. They are genuine, so check your spam folder.

What this means for you

- **All three answers count equally.** Your third choice could be the one that gets allocated. Don't write it lazily.
- **You compete inside a slate of ~25–50**, not against thousands. Being clearly the best-informed person in that pile is very achievable.
- **Some firms decide on paper alone.** The FAQ warns that some reject from the CV and cover letter without an interview, so the writing has to carry you.
- **Location is a lever.** More roles in a location means more chances of an allocation. Pick somewhere you can genuinely get to.
- **Speed matters.** First contact is 24 Nov–4 Dec. Missing a firm's deadline can lose the allocation.

The 2026/27 timeline

- **28 Sep – 30 Oct 2026** Employers pledge roles
- **Today → 1 Nov 2026** **Write, proofread and submit.** Applications close 1 November.
- **By end Nov 2026** Everyone gets an email with their allocation information
- **23 Nov 2026** Employer slates released in Pinpoint
- **24 Nov – 4 Dec 2026** First contact from firms. **Respond fast.**
- **By 19 Feb 2027** Recommended deadline for interviews and assessments
- **By 19 Mar 2027** Recommended deadline for offers
- **By 31 May 2027** Hires confirmed (late allocations possible until June)
- **Apr – Jun 2027** Pre-internship training
- **May – Sep 2027** Internships (minimum 6 weeks, Real Living Wage or above)

Employer dates are the Foundation's "recommended" milestones. Individual firms run their own timelines, so some will be faster and some slower.

PART 3

Who actually reads your 250 words

Picture the reader. Late November: a hiring manager or early-careers recruiter at **one firm** opens Pinpoint and sees a slate of about 40 people. For each candidate they see a CV and a 250-word answer. They might spend **one to two minutes** per person. They are asking four questions:

1. Motivation
Is this a real choice or a box ticked?

2. Understanding
Do they know what we actually do?

3. Evidence
Have they done anything that proves it?

4. Fit
Could I put them in front of a colleague or client in week one?

The "random firm" problem, solved

You can't tailor to one company because you don't know which one you'll get. "Investment Management" might mean a £1 trillion global manager, a 30-person boutique, a wealth manager or an insurer's in-house investment arm. The answer is to **tailor to the workstream's common core**, meaning the things that are true at every firm in that pool:

Workstream	Common core every host shares	Phrases that show understanding
Investment Management	They manage other people's money for a fee based on assets. Growth comes from performance plus winning and keeping clients.	"assets under management", "net flows", "client retention", "explaining the investment process"
Sales	Revenue depends on finding, converting and keeping customers. Results are measured in pipeline, conversion and targets.	"understanding the client's problem", "pipeline", "account management", "repeat business"
Public Relations	They protect and build reputation through earned media and messaging. Agencies sell expertise by the hour or on retainer.	"key messages", "media relations", "coverage", "issues and crisis", "stakeholders"

The golden rule

Specific about the **industry**, specific about **you**, neutral about the **firm**. Never write a firm's name, "your firm's values" or "your graduate scheme". You don't know who will read it, and a generic flattering line wastes words.

Should you tailor Investment Management to the client-facing side?

Yes, as your spine, but leave the door open. The allocation is random within the workstream, so the role you're matched to could be in an investment team, operations or distribution. If your answer says "I only want sales" you may put off an investment-team reader. If it says "I want to work on the client-facing side, *and to do that well I want to understand how portfolios are built*", every reader in the pool can say yes. Your previous asset-management experience makes that line believable.

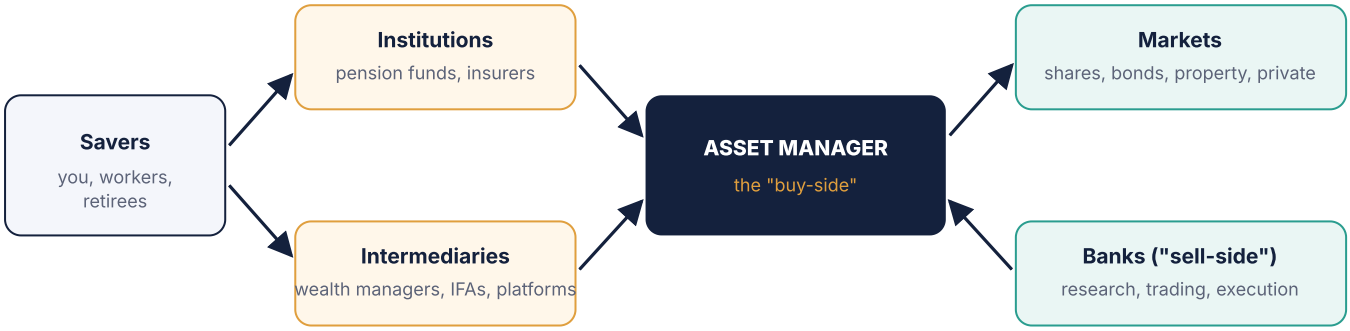
A note on coherence: your three choices don't need to be connected. Each is a separate lottery ticket read by a different reader. But there is a natural thread you *can* use in your head: **IM distribution** is a form of B2B **sales**, and asset managers rely heavily on **financial PR**. Use that thread for your own understanding. Don't make the Sales or PR answers about finance only, because that reader might be a software company or a consumer PR agency.

PART 4 · FIRST CHOICE

Investment Management

An asset manager pools money from savers (through pensions, ISAs and insurance policies) and invests it in shares, bonds, property and private assets on their behalf, for a fee. The UK industry manages around **£9 trillion**, second only to the US.

Pre-knowledge: where it sits in the money system



Investment consultants (Mercer, WTW, Aon, Redington, LCP...) advise institutions on which managers to hire.

AUM	Assets under management: the total money a firm manages. The single most important number, because fees are a percentage of it.
bps (basis points)	1 bp = 0.01%. A fee of 50 bps = 0.50% a year. Fees are always discussed in bps.
Active vs passive	Active: managers pick investments to beat a benchmark. Passive: track an index cheaply (e.g. an ETF tracking the FTSE 100).
Benchmark / alpha	The index a fund is measured against. Alpha is return above that benchmark, which is what active managers sell.
Net flows	New client money in minus money withdrawn. Positive flows mean the business is winning.
Fund vs mandate	Fund: a pooled product many investors buy into (OEIC, unit trust, ETF, investment trust). Mandate: a bespoke portfolio run for one large client.
DB vs DC pensions	Defined benefit: guaranteed pension, so the scheme carries the risk. Defined contribution: your pot depends on investment returns. DC is where the growth is.
Private markets	Investments not on a stock exchange: private equity, private credit, infrastructure, real estate. Higher fees and a fast-growing area.
RFP	Request for proposal: a formal questionnaire a client or consultant sends when choosing a manager.

Types of firm you could be allocated to

Global "traditional" managers
Large active and passive ranges: e.g. LGIM, Schroders, M&G, abrdn, BlackRock, Fidelity.

Boutiques
Small, specialist, often owned by their partners. You'll see a bit of everything.

Alternatives
Hedge funds (e.g. Capstone), private equity (Permira, Livingbridge), private credit (Ares).

Wealth managers
Manage money for individuals and families: St James's Place, Canaccord, Rathbones.

Insurers / pension investors
In-house teams at insurers and big pension schemes, i.e. asset owners.

Consultants / platforms
Advise on or distribute managers. Close cousins that sometimes sit in this workstream.

PART 4 · INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT

The four parts of an asset manager

1. Investment (front office)

- Portfolio managers
- Research analysts
- Dealers / traders
- Strategists, economists

Goal: generate returns that beat the benchmark within agreed risk limits.

2. Distribution (client-facing)

- Institutional sales / BD
- Wholesale sales
- Client relationship mgmt
- Consultant relations
- Product specialists
- RFP, marketing

Goal: win new assets and keep existing clients. This is where the revenue is won.

3. Operations, risk & tech

- Investment risk
- Performance measurement
- Fund operations, trade settlement
- Data and technology

Goal: run portfolios accurately, safely and efficiently.

4. Corporate functions

- Compliance and legal
- Finance
- HR
- Responsible investment / stewardship

Goal: keep the firm regulated (FCA), solvent and well-governed.

Gold outline = the client-facing side you're most interested in.

How an asset manager makes money

Revenue per year = **AUM** money managed × **Fee rate** in bps + **Performance fees** some products only

Worked example

A pension fund gives a manager a **£500m** mandate at **40 bps**. £500,000,000 × 0.40% = **£2m of revenue a year**, every year the client stays.
If the client leaves after a bad meeting, £2m a year walks out.
That is why client relationship teams exist.

So AUM grows in only two ways

1. Markets / performance: the investments rise in value (partly luck, partly skill, and the investment team's job).
2. Net flows: clients add money or new clients arrive (the distribution team's job).
Costs are mostly people, so once a fund is running, extra AUM is very profitable.

Product type	Typical annual fee (rough)	Why
Passive index fund / ETF	0.03% – 0.25%	Simple, automated, and very price-competitive
Active equity or bond, institutional	0.25% – 0.75%	Large clients negotiate hard
Active fund, retail / wholesale	0.60% – 1.00%	Smaller tickets and more servicing
Hedge fund	~1–2% + ~20% of profits	Specialist skill, performance-based
Private equity / private credit	~1–2% + ~20% "carry"	Illiquid, long-term, labour-intensive

PART 4 · INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT

Close-up: the client-facing side

In asset management, the client side is usually called **distribution**. It splits by **who the client is**:

Institutional

Clients: DB and DC pension schemes, local government pension pools (LGPS), insurers, sovereign wealth funds, charities, university endowments.

How they buy: slowly and formally. Usually an investment consultant shortlists managers, then RFPs, then a pitch to the trustees. Sales cycles take months, and mandates are worth hundreds of millions.

Wholesale / intermediary

Clients: wealth managers, discretionary fund managers (DFMs), independent financial advisers (IFAs), private banks, and platforms such as Hargreaves Lansdown.

How they buy: fund selectors research funds and add them to "buy lists". More meetings, smaller tickets, and a lot of regional travel.

Retail / direct

Clients: individual investors buying funds or ISAs directly.

How they buy: through marketing, digital channels and brand. They are driven by FCA **Consumer Duty**, which requires firms to show good outcomes and fair value.

The roles, and what an intern would do in each

Role	What they do	Intern-level tasks
Business development / sales	Win new clients and mandates; build the pipeline	Prospect research, CRM updates, pitch-book preparation
Client relationship manager	Own existing clients, keep them happy, spot cross-sell opportunities	Prepare meeting packs, take notes, track client requests
Consultant relations	Manage the relationship with consultants such as Mercer and WTW, who influence which managers get hired	Answer consultant databases, collate performance data
Product specialist / investment director	Explain a strategy in depth: the bridge between the fund manager and the client	Draft market commentary, update factsheets and presentations
Client service / reporting	Accurate quarterly reports, onboarding, queries	Check reports, reconcile data, handle simple queries
RFP / proposals	Write the formal answers that win or lose tenders	Update the answer library, draft standard sections
Marketing	Brand, campaigns, thought leadership, events	Content drafts, event support, campaign analytics

What's happening in the industry right now (use *one*, in a single sentence)

Fee compression and passive growth. Cheap index funds keep taking share, so active managers must justify their fees. Clear explanation of value becomes the job of distribution.

Private markets go mainstream. Managers are launching private-market products for pensions and wealthy individuals (e.g. LTAFs). There is a lot of client education involved.

UK pension reform. DC schemes and LGPS pools are consolidating into fewer, larger "megafunds", and the government is pushing more investment into UK assets. Fewer, bigger, more demanding clients.

Consolidation and cost pressure. Mergers, job cuts and AI-driven automation. Firms want people who add value quickly.

Sustainability and stewardship. Clients ask how managers vote and engage with companies. FCA sustainability labels (SDR) shape how funds are marketed.

PART 5 · SECOND CHOICE

Sales

Sales connects a product or service with the customer who needs it, and turns that need into revenue. The Foundation notes that about **1 in 6 UK employees** work in sales-related roles. The Sales workstream can include technology and software, consumer goods, business services, media, telecoms and financial services.

Pre-knowledge

B2B vs B2C	Business-to-business (selling to companies: longer cycles, several decision-makers) vs business-to-consumer (selling to individuals: faster, higher volume).
Pipeline	All the potential deals in progress, at each stage, with an estimated value.
Conversion rate	The share of prospects that move to the next stage, or that eventually buy.
Quota / target	The revenue a salesperson is expected to bring in. Pay is often base salary plus commission ("OTE", on-target earnings).
ARR / recurring revenue	Revenue that repeats (subscriptions, contracts). It is highly valued, because keeping customers is cheaper than finding new ones.
Churn	Customers lost over a period. Low churn means healthy account management.
CAC and LTV	Cost to acquire a customer vs their lifetime value. LTV should be well above CAC. Every deal is logged in a **CRM** (e.g. Salesforce).

The four parts of a sales organisation

1. Lead generation

- SDR / BDR roles
- Research prospects
- Cold outreach, calls, emails
- Book first meetings

Goal: fill the top of the pipeline

2. New business

- Account executives
- Discovery meetings
- Proposals and demos
- Negotiation and closing

Goal: convert prospects into paying customers

3. Account management

- Key account managers
- Customer success
- Renewals and upselling
- Relationship building

Goal: keep and grow existing customers

4. Sales ops & strategy

- Pipeline data and CRM
- Forecasting
- Pricing and territories
- Sales enablement and training

Goal: make the whole engine more efficient

The funnel (illustrative B2B)



Improve any one stage and revenue rises. That is why sales is so data-driven.

How sales makes money



6 deals × £30k a year × an average stay of 4 years = **£720k lifetime value** from one quarter's work. Losing a client early wipes that out, which is why **account management** is as important as closing.

Your bridge into Sales

Asset-management distribution **is** consultative B2B sales: long cycles, several decision-makers (trustees, consultants), formal proposals (RFPs), and revenue that depends on retention. If you saw any of that in your previous role, you have watched high-value sales up close. In the Sales answer, describe it in **sales language** (prospect, pipeline, relationship, follow-up, objection) so a software or consumer-goods reader recognises it. Then add one non-finance example of persuading or serving people (a part-time job, a society, fundraising) to show range. For interviews, know **consultative selling** and **SPIN** questioning. If asked to "sell me this pen", ask about the buyer before you pitch.

PART 6 · THIRD CHOICE

Public Relations

PR manages how an organisation or person is **seen** by the media, customers, investors, regulators, politicians and employees. Advertising is space you pay for. PR is mostly about **earned** attention, which you have to persuade a journalist or audience to give you.

Pre-knowledge: the PESO model

Paid	Earned	Shared	Owned
Adverts, sponsored content, paid social	Press coverage, interviews, reviews. **The core of PR.**	Social media, influencers, word of mouth	Website, blog, reports, newsletters

Press release	A formal announcement written like a news story, sent to journalists.
Media list	A database of relevant journalists, outlets and their interests. Building these is classic intern work.
Pitch	A short, tailored email persuading a journalist that a story or expert is worth their time.
Key messages	The three or four points an organisation wants every audience to remember.
Share of voice	Your coverage compared with competitors'. A standard PR success measure.
Thought leadership	Positioning executives as experts through comment pieces, research and interviews.
Public affairs	Influencing policy and regulation by engaging politicians, civil servants and regulators.

The main parts of PR

1. Corporate & financial

- Company results
- M&A, IPOs
- Investor relations
- CEO profile

Goal: protect value and trust with investors and the City

2. Consumer & brand

- Product launches
- Campaigns and stunts
- Influencers and social
- Events

Goal: make customers notice, like and buy

3. Crisis & issues

- Scandals, failures
- Data breaches
- Holding statements
- Spokesperson prep

Goal: limit damage, fast and honestly

4. Public affairs & internal

- Policy and lobbying
- Stakeholder engagement
- Employee comms
- ESG messaging

Goal: shape the rules and keep staff aligned

PART 6 · PUBLIC RELATIONS

How PR makes money, and your bridge

Agency side (most PR internships)

An agency sells **people's time and judgement** to clients:

- **Retainers:** a monthly fee for ongoing work (e.g. £10k–£50k+ a month for a large corporate client)
- **Projects:** one-off fees for a launch, campaign or deal
- **Crisis work:** billed at high hourly rates when something goes wrong

Profit = fees − staff costs, so agencies track **billable hours** and win new clients through pitches, which is sales again. An intern who saves a senior consultant time is directly valuable.

In-house side

A communications team inside a company, such as a bank, retailer, charity or asset manager. It is a **cost centre**: it doesn't bill anyone, so its value is shown through:

- quality and quantity of coverage, and share of voice
- reputation and trust scores
- crises avoided or contained
- support for sales, recruitment and investor confidence

A day in a PR internship

08:30 Morning media monitoring: what's been written about clients

10:00 Update media lists, research journalists

12:00 Draft a press release or social post

15:00 Help prepare a client meeting or event

17:00 Coverage report: what landed and where

Your bridge into PR: financial communications

Asset managers spend heavily on communications. Fund managers are quoted in the **FT, Bloomberg, Citywire, Investment Week, Money Marketing and Professional Pensions**. Firms publish market outlooks, and a single bad story can trigger client withdrawals. The 2019 suspension of the Woodford Equity Income fund is the classic example of reputation turning into lost assets almost overnight. Financial and corporate PR firms in the UK include Brunswick, FGS Global, Teneo, Headland, Lansons, Instinctif, Citigate Dewe Rogerson and Montfort (which supports 10K itself). Consumer and broad agencies include Edelman, Weber Shandwick, MHP and Freuds.

How to use this: say you've seen first-hand that in finance *trust is the product*, and that clear communication protects it. Then show you can write, research and work to deadlines. Keep it broad enough that a consumer agency reader still nods along. Mention the financial angle once, not throughout.

What PR readers look for that other workstreams don't: writing quality (your 250 words *are* the writing sample, so any typo is fatal), **news sense** (follow the news and be able to name a recent campaign or crisis you found interesting and why), **organisation under pressure**, and **confidence on the phone**.

PART 7

Writing the answers

The form asks for **100–250 words** and says to "maximise the word count". Aim for **230–250**. Use this five-part structure for every answer:

Hook ~30	Understanding of the industry ~60	Evidence: your specific story ~90	What you'll contribute and learn ~50	Close ~20

Part	What it does	Test
Hook	One sharp sentence on why *this* industry, based on an insight, not a feeling	Could another applicant have written it? If yes, rewrite.
Understanding	Show that you know how the business works and makes money, plus one live issue	Does it use the industry's own terms correctly?
Evidence	One concrete example: what you did, how, and the result. Numbers where honest.	Is there a verb you did, not just something you "were exposed to"?
Contribute / learn	What you bring from week one, and what you want to learn there	Is it believable for an intern?
Close	A forward-looking line tying it together	No "thank you for your consideration". It wastes words.

The specificity ladder

Level	Example line (Investment Management)
Weak	"I am passionate about finance and want to develop my skills in a fast-paced environment."
OK	"My internship in asset management showed me how investment teams work and sparked my interest in the industry."
Strong	"At [firm], helping prepare quarterly reports for pension clients showed me that assets are kept through trust as much as performance: a £500m mandate at 40 basis points is £2m a year that depends on every meeting going well."

Do

- One main story per answer, told properly
- Use **different** stories across the three answers where you can
- Use industry vocabulary *correctly*, a few terms, not a glossary
- British spelling, short sentences, active voice
- Read it aloud, then get one other person to proofread it
- Write it in a doc first and count the words there

Don't

- Name a firm, or write "your company"
- Say "this is my second / third choice"
- Copy and paste a paragraph across answers
- List adjectives ("hard-working, passionate, driven")
- Over-claim (e.g. "I managed a portfolio" when you supported one)
- Paste in AI text unchanged. Readers spot it, and it sounds like everyone else.

PART 7 · TEMPLATES

Draft 1: Investment Management

Highlighted brackets are where your real details go. Replace every one with something true and specific, then cut or add to land between 230 and 250 words. These are scaffolds, not answers to submit as they are.

Every pension, ISA and insurance policy ultimately relies on an asset manager, so how that money is invested, and how clearly it is explained, shapes whether people can retire with confidence. That responsibility is why I want to build a career in investment management.

During my internship at **[firm]**, I saw that strong performance alone does not grow a business. Revenue is a percentage of assets under management, so it depends on winning and keeping clients who understand and trust the investment process. I **[specific task, e.g. helped prepare quarterly reports for institutional clients / updated fund factsheets / supported an RFP response]**, which taught me **[specific lesson, e.g. how much accuracy matters when a pension trustee reads your numbers]**.

I am most drawn to the client-facing side of the industry, including relationship management, institutional and wholesale sales, and product specialist roles, but to do that well I want to understand how portfolios are built and how decisions are made across asset classes. With fee pressure, the growth of passive funds and UK pension consolidation creating fewer, larger and more demanding clients, explaining value clearly has never mattered more.

I would bring **[skills, e.g. strong Excel and PowerPoint, research experience from my degree in X]**, the professionalism I developed at **[firm]**, and a daily habit of **[e.g. following markets through the FT and Citywire]**. I want to contribute from my first week and finish the internship knowing exactly where I can add the most value.

≈ 245 words with placeholders filled briefly

Why this works: the hook is an insight rather than a feeling. Paragraph 2 proves understanding (AUM-based revenue) *through* your experience. Paragraph 3 states the client-facing interest while keeping investment-team readers on side. A live industry issue appears in one sentence. There is no firm name anywhere.

PART 7 · TEMPLATES

Draft 2: Sales

The best salespeople I have watched rarely pitch first. They ask questions until they understand a client's problem better than the client expected, and only then explain how they can help. I want a sales internship to learn that skill properly, because every business depends on it.

At **[firm]**, I supported the team responsible for winning and retaining clients. I **[specific task, e.g. researched prospective clients before meetings / prepared pitch materials / logged follow-ups in the CRM]** and saw that long sales cycles are won through preparation, persistent follow-up and trust built over many conversations. Outside finance, **[non-finance example, e.g. my part-time retail role, where I consistently exceeded my weekly target / raising £X in sponsorship for my society]** taught me to handle rejection, adapt my approach to different people and keep going.

I understand that sales drives revenue directly. A healthy pipeline, strong conversion and, above all, retaining existing customers decide whether a business hits its targets, because every client lost has to be replaced. That is why I am especially interested in B2B sales and account management, where relationships compound over time.

During an internship I want to shadow experienced professionals, learn how they qualify opportunities and handle objections, and use sales data to understand where deals are won or lost. I would bring **[skills]**, confidence speaking with senior people, and a genuine curiosity about what customers need.

≈ 240 words with placeholders filled briefly

PART 7 · TEMPLATES

Draft 3: Public Relations

A reputation can take decades to build and a single headline to damage. I want to work in public relations because I have seen how directly an organisation's success depends on what people believe about it, and how much skill it takes to shape that belief honestly.

At **[firm]**, I saw how carefully an investment business communicates. Market commentary, client updates and comments in the financial press all exist to maintain trust, because in finance trust is the product and a poorly handled story can lead clients to withdraw. **[Specific task, e.g. I helped draft a client update / summarised market news each morning]**, which showed me the value of writing that is clear, accurate and quick.

I understand PR covers media relations, corporate and financial communications, consumer campaigns, crisis management and public affairs, and that success is measured in coverage, message and reputation rather than effort. I am particularly interested in **[corporate and financial communications / crisis work]**, and I follow how organisations handle **[a recent campaign or crisis you found interesting]**.

I would bring strong writing, shown through **[e.g. articles for my student paper / society social media that grew to X followers]**, careful research, and calm organisation under deadlines. I am ready to build media lists, draft press releases and monitor coverage from day one, while learning how experienced practitioners turn a client's goals into stories journalists want to tell.

≈ 245 words with placeholders filled briefly

PART 8

Strategy beyond the form

1. Pick your location deliberately

Matching is by workstream **and** location. London has the most host roles in all three of your workstreams, especially IM and PR. If you can do London, choose it. If you can't, choose the nearest major hub where you could genuinely live for 6+ weeks (Edinburgh, Manchester, Leeds, Birmingham and Bristol all have asset managers).

2. Lock the CV before 1 November

It can't be edited later. Make your asset-management bullets results-focused ("prepared X for Y clients", "reduced Z"), and put it first. It is your biggest differentiator on a slate of 40.

3. Treat the cover letter field seriously

The FAQ says your CV *and cover letter* go to each allocated organisation. Keep the general cover letter firm-neutral, one page, and consistent with your three answers.

4. Respond within 24 hours, 24 Nov – 4 Dec

That is when firms make first contact. Set a Gmail filter for "Pinpoint" and "10,000", check spam daily, and diarise each firm's deadline. Missing one can lose the allocation, and 10K cannot reopen it.

5. Prepare for the firm's own process

Expect any of: online tests or psychometrics, a HireVue video, a written exercise, interviews. For IM, be ready for: "Pitch me a fund or stock", "How does an asset manager make money?", "What's happening in markets?", "Why the client side?"

6. Don't rely on 10K alone

Allocations aren't guaranteed and are random. Apply **directly** to the asset managers you most want (the 10K employer FAQ itself tells unallocated candidates to do this), and use the 10K training sessions. They count towards applications outside the programme too.

Your plan: 11 October → 1 November

When	Do this
This week (by 17 Oct)	Re-read Parts 4–6. Write down 3–4 true stories from your AM experience and one non-finance story. Finalise location. Update CV.
18 – 24 Oct	Draft all three answers from the templates. Leave them for a day, then cut every generic sentence. Check that each answer stands alone.
25 – 28 Oct	Get two readers: one who knows finance, one who doesn't. Fix anything either finds confusing. Read each answer aloud. Check word counts (230–250).
29 – 30 Oct	**Submit early.** Don't leave it to 1 November, when forms crash and you rush. Screenshot or save your answers.
Nov → Mar	Respond fast, prepare per firm, keep applying directly, and attend 10K interview training.

Final pre-submit checklist

- ☐ Each answer 230–250 words
- ☐ No firm names, no "my second choice"
- ☐ Each answer has one concrete story with a result
- ☐ Each uses 2–3 correct industry terms
- ☐ Different stories across the three answers
- ☐ British spelling, zero typos (read aloud)
- ☐ CV final; location chosen deliberately
- ☐ Right-to-work status in place and correct

APPENDIX

Sources

- 10,000 Interns Foundation: 10,000 Black Interns programme page and workstream descriptions: 10000internsfoundation.com/students-graduates/10000-black-interns/
- 10,000 Interns Foundation: Students & Graduates FAQs (closing date, allocation, reallocation, CV, timeline): 10000internsfoundation.com/students-graduates/students-graduates-faqs/
- 10,000 Interns Foundation: Employer FAQs (random matching by workstream and location, 25–50 candidates per role, no hosting fee, pay and length requirements, 2026/27 recruitment timeline, 250-word cover letters): 10000internsfoundation.com/employers/employers-faqs/
- 10,000 Interns Foundation: Employers, Become a Member, Funders/Partners and home page (milestones, 1,300+ employers, partner list)
- Charity Commission register: The 10,000 Interns Foundation, charity no. 1199061, financial history
- Investment Week: "Leading investment management figures launch Black interns campaign" (founders, pilot hosts)
- Insurance Business: "Almost 500 firms have joined 10,000 Black Interns campaign"; DiversityQ; eFinancialCareers coverage of the pilot
- Trillium, Canaccord Genuity Wealth Management, OneFamily, Pinsent Masons and Framestore pages on their participation; Bar Council 10,000 Black Interns pages
- Montfort: PRWeek UK Industry Initiative Award for the 10,000 Black Interns campaign

Industry figures (UK AUM of around £9trn, fee ranges, PR retainer sizes, funnel numbers) are rounded, typical figures for understanding. Don't quote them as precise statistics in your application. Host employers named in press coverage come from past cycles and are not a confirmed 2027 list.